THE BUBBLE: A POEM.



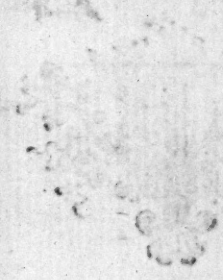
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A

POEM.



THE *BUBBLE:* A POEM

YE wiſe Philoſophers explain
What Magick makes our Money riſe,
When dropt into the *Southern* Main;
Or do theſe Juglers cheat our Eyes?

Put in your Money fairly told;
Preſto be gone--- 'Tis here agen:
Ladies, and Gentlemen, behold,
Here's ev'ry Piece as big as Ten.

Thus in a Baſin drop a Shilling,
Then fill the Veſſel to the Brim;
You ſhall obſerve, as you are filling,
The pond'rous Metal ſeems to ſwim:

It riſes both in Bulk and Height,
Behold it mounting to the Top;
The liquid Medium cheats your Sight,
Behold it ſwelling like a Sop.

In Stock Three Hundred Thouſand Pounds;
I have in View a Lord's Eſtate;
My Mannors all contiguous round;
A Coach and Six, and ſerv'd in Plate.

Thus the deluded Bankrupt raves,
Puts all upon a deſp'rate Bett;
Then plunges in the *Southern* Waves,
Dipt over Head and Ears——in Debt.

So, by a Calenture miſled,
The Mariner with Rapture ſees,
On the ſmooth Ocean's azure Bed,
Enamel'd Fields, and verdant Trees.

With eager Haſte he longs to rove
In that fantaſtick Scene, and thinks
It muſt be ſome enchanted Grove;
And in he leaps, and down he ſinks.

Rais'd up on Hope's aſpiring Plumes,
The young Advent'rer o'er the Deep
An Eagle's Flight and State aſſumes,
And ſcorns the middle Way to keep:

On *Paper* Wings he takes his Flight,
With *Wax* the *Father* bound them faſt;
The *Wax* is melted by the Height,
And down the tow'ring Boy is caſt.

A Moraliſt might here explain
The Raſhneſs of the *Cretan* Youth,
Deſcribe his Fall into the Main,
And from a Fable form a Truth.

His *Wings* are his *Paternal Rent*,
He melts his *Wax* at ev'ry Flame;
His Credit ſunk, his Money ſpent,
In Southern *Seas he leaves his Name.*

Inform us, You, that beſt can tell,
Why in yon dang'rous Gulph profound,
Where Hundreds and where Thouſands fell,
Fools chiefly float, the *Wiſe* are drown'd.

So have I ſeen from *Severn*'s Brink
A Flock of *Geeſe* jump down together;
Swim, where the Bird of *Jove* would ſink,
And ſwimming, never wet a Feather.

But

But I affirm, 'tis falſe in Fact,
Directors better know their Tools;
We ſee the Nation's Credit crackt,
Each Knave hath made a Thouſand Fools.

One Fool may from another win,
And then get off with Money ſtor'd;
But if a *Sharper* once gets in,
He throws at all, and ſweeps the Board.

As Fiſhes on each other prey,
The great Ones ſwallowing up the Small;
So fares it in the *Southern* Sea:
But Whale *Directors* eat up all.

When *Stock* is high, they come between,
Making by ſecond-hand their Offers;
Then cunningly retire unſeen,
With each a Million in his Coffers.

So when upon a Moon-ſhine Night,
An Aſs was drinking at a Stream;
A Cloud aroſe, and ſtopt the Light,
By intercepting ev'ry Beam:

The Day of Judgment will be ſoon,
Cries out a Sage among the Croud;
An Aſs hath ſwallow'd up the Moon:
The Moon lay ſafe behind the Cloud.

Each

Each poor *Subſcriber* to the Sea,
Sinks down at once, and there he lies;
Directors fall as well as they:
Their Fall is but a Trick to riſe.

So Fiſhes riſing from the Main,
Can ſoar with moiſten'd Wings on high;
The Moiſture dry'd, they ſink again,
And dip their Fins again to fly.

Undone at Play, the Female Troops
Come here their Loſſes to retrieve;
Ride o'er the Waves in ſpacious Hoops,
Like *Lapland* Witches in a Sieve.

Thus *Venus* to the Sea deſcends,
As Poets feign; but where's the Moral?
It ſhews the Queen of Love intends
To ſearch the Deep for Pearl and Coral.

The Sea is richer than the Land,
I heard it from my Grannam's Mouth;
Which now I clearly underſtand,
For by the Sea ſhe meant the *South*.

Thus by *Directors* we are told,
Pray, Gentlemen, believe your Eyes;
Our Ocean's cover'd o'er with Gold,
Look round about how thick it lies:

We, Gentlemen, are your Aſſiſters,
We'll come and hold you by the Chin;
Alas! all is not Gold that gliſters:
Ten thouſand ſunk by leaping in.

Oh! would theſe Patriots be ſo kind,
Here in the Deep to *waſh their Hands*;
Then, like *Pactolus*, we ſhould find,
The Sea indeed had *Golden Sands*.

A Shilling in the *Bath* you fling,
The Silver takes a nobler Hue,
By Magick Virtue in the Spring,
And ſeems a Guinea to your View:

But as a Guinea will not paſs
At Market for a Farthing more,
Shewn thro a multiplying Glaſs,
Than what it always did before;

So caſt it in the *Southern* Seas,
And view it through a *Jobber*'s Bill;
Put on what Spectacles you pleaſe,
Your Guinea's but a Guinea ſtill.

One Night a Fool into a Brook,
Thus from a Hillock looking down,
The *Golden* Stars for Guineas took,
And *Silver Cynthia* for a Crown.

The

The Point he could no longer doubt,
He ran, he leapt into the Flood;
There ſprawl'd a while, at laſt got out,
All cover'd o'er with Slime and Mud.

Upon the Water caſt thy Bread,
And after many Days thou'lt find it;
But Gold upon this Ocean ſpread,
Shall ſink, and leave no Mark behind it.

There is a Gulph where Thouſands fell,
Here all the bold Advent'rers came;
A narrow Sound, though deep as Hell,
Change-Alley is the dreadful Name:

Nine times a Day it ebbs and flows,
Yet he that on the Surface lies,
Without a Pilot ſeldom knows
The Time it falls, or when 'twill riſe.

Subſcribers here by Thouſands float,
And juſtle one another down;
Each padling in his leaky Boat,
And here they fiſh for Gold, and drown.

* *Now bury'd in the Depth below,*
Now mounted up to Heaven again;
They reel and ſtagger to and fro,
At their Wits end, like drunken Men.

* Pſalm 107.

Mean time ſecure on * *Garr'way*'s Cliffs,
A Savage Race by Shipwrecks fed,
Lie waiting for the founder'd Skiffs,
And ſtrip the Bodies of the Dead.

But theſe, you ſay, are factious Lyes,
From ſome malicious Tory's Brain;
For, where Directors get a Prize,
The *Swiſs* and *Dutch* whole Millions drain.

Thus when by Rooks a Lord is ply'd,
Some Cully often wins a Bett,
By vent'ring on the cheating Side,
Tho not into the Secret let.

While ſome build Caſtles in the Air,
Directors build 'em in the Seas;
Subſcribers plainly ſee them there,
For Fools will ſee as Wiſe-Men pleaſe.

Thus oft by Mariners are ſhewn,
Unleſs the Men of *Kent* are Lyars,
Earl Godwin's Caſtles overflown,
And Caſtle-Roofs, and Steeple-Spires.

Mark where the ſly *Directors* creep,
Nor to the Shore approach too nigh;
The Monſters neſtle in the Deep,
To ſeize you in your paſſing by;

Then,

* *Coffee-Houſe in* Change-Alley.

Then, like the Dogs of *Nile*, be wiſe,
Who taught, by Inſtinct, how to ſhun
The Crocodile, that lurking lies,
Run as they drink, and drink and run.

Antæus could, by Magick Charms,
Recover Strength whene'er he fell;
Alcides held him in his Arms,
And ſent him *up in Air* to Hell.

Directors thrown into the Sea,
Recover Strength and Vigour there;
But may be tam'd another way,
Suſpended for a while in Air.

Directors! for 'tis you I warn,
By long Experience we have found
What Planet rul'd when you were born;
We ſee you never can be drown'd:

Beware, nor over-bulky grow,
Nor come within your Cully's Reach;
For if the Sea ſhould ſink ſo low,
To leave you dry upon the Beach;

You'll owe your Ruin to your Bulk;
Your Foes already waiting ſtand,
To tear you like a founder'd Hulk,
While you lie helpleſs on the Sand.

Thus

Thus when a Whale hath loſt the Tide,
The Coaſters crowd to ſeize the Spoil;
The Monſter into Parts divide,
And ſtrip the Bone, and melt the Oil.

Oh! may ſome *Weſtern* Tempeſt ſweep
Theſe *Locuſts*, whom our Fruits have fed,
That Plague, *Directors*, to the Deep,
Driven from the *South-Sea* to the *Red.*

May He, whom Nature's Laws obey,
Who *lifts* the Poor, and *ſinks* the Proud,
Quiet the Raging of the Sea,
And *ſtill the Madneſs of the Croud.*

But never ſhall our Iſle have Reſt,
Till thoſe devouring *Swine* run down,
(The Devil's leaving the Poſſeſt)
And *headlong in the Waters drown.*

The Nation too too late will find,
Computing all their Coſt and Trouble,
Directors Promiſes but Wind,
South-Sea at beſt a mighty *Bubble.*

F I N I S.